

ART THEORY & DIGITAL PRACTICE REFERENCE

Professional-Grade Art Theory and Digital Knowledge
Required for Planning and Completing a Digital Art Piece
from Beginning to Completion

Classical Theory • Modern Theory • Stage-by-Stage Guidance
Fully Research-Grounded • Subject-Agnostic • Written for the Human Artist

Audience	Art hobbyists who want professional-level guidance that follows established rules of art theory from first idea to finished piece.
How this document is used	You (the human artist) create every image. An AI may read this document to give you advice. Neither the document nor the AI ever creates, edits, or modifies any image.
Version	5.0 — Full theoretical and structural depth restored; only framing corrections applied; complete source URLs in bibliography.
Evidence rule	Every numerical standard and technical claim is drawn from published sources. No invented ranges. Full direct URLs appear in the Bibliography.
Subject rule	Fully subject-agnostic. No anatomy, markings, or surface systems for any particular motif.

This document supplies the theory and the practical checkpoints so that when you ask an AI for help at any stage of making a digital artwork, the advice you receive is complete, grounded in established art theory and real technical standards, and free of made-up numbers. You remain the only person who draws, paints, adjusts, and exports the image.

1. PURPOSE, SCOPE, AND METHOD

1.1 Purpose

The purpose is to give you a single reference that covers the professional knowledge required to plan and finish a digital art piece. An AI can use it to answer your questions at any point from first idea to final delivery. You do all of the actual image-making.

1.2 Scope

- Classical elements of art and principles of design as taught in art foundations curricula.
- General structural and proportional thinking applicable across subject matter.
- Color theory required for controlled rendering under any lighting idea.
- A complete stage-by-stage path from project decisions through export and archive.
- Real-world resolution, color-space, and delivery requirements taken from print houses and platforms.
- Observational checks and common failure patterns you can apply yourself.
- Explicit mapping of theory to each stage of work.

1.3 Explicit non-assumptions

- No prior formal art education is assumed; terms are defined.
- No specific software is required; principles are tool-agnostic.
- No single style register is prescribed.
- No specific subject matter is referenced.
- No assumption that you own high-end calibrated studio hardware.
- The AI never sees or edits your image; all visual checks are performed by you.

1.4 Method

Content follows two axes: (1) theoretical foundations from classical to modern, and (2) a linear production sequence in which each stage receives its governing theory, the actions you take, and the conditions that let you move forward. All numerical and technical claims are tied to published sources listed with full URLs in the Bibliography.

2. PROJECT DEFINITION FRAMEWORK

2.1 What you are making

A digital art piece created by you inside a raster, vector, or hybrid program. The exact subject, style, and purpose are defined by you in the project brief.

2.2 Decisions to lock before you begin drawing

Published illustrator and concept-art process descriptions consistently begin by recording a short set of decisions. Write them down before the first mark.

Decision	Options / notes	Effect on later work
Style register	Photoreal / detailed realism / stylized / graphic / abstract	Controls edge treatment, detail density, color simplification
Lighting idea	Single key+fill / soft diffuse / dramatic / colored lights / multiple sources	Sets value structure and color-temperature plan
Viewpoint	Eye-level / high / low / strong foreshortening / flat	Determines perspective complexity
Background treatment	None / simple tone / suggestive / fully realized	Affects atmospheric and edge work later
Output goal	Screen only / print / both	Decides color space and resolution floor (Section 6)
Working size	Final pixel dimensions and, if print is possible, PPI target	Set canvas to final size from the start; upscaling loses quality
Color space & bit depth	sRGB (screen-only) or wider space if print is likely; 16-bit while working if practical	Protects color and reduces banding

Decision-list approach drawn from published illustrator process descriptions and concept-art pre-production practice.

2.3 Definition of done

The piece is finished when all of the following are true:

- Structural construction is consistent with the proportional and formal landmarks required by your chosen viewpoint.
- Value structure supports clear form reading at both full size and reduced thumbnail scale.
- Color relationships remain coherent under the lighting idea you chose.
- Edge hierarchy (hard, soft, lost) reinforces focal priority and depth.
- File is still layered and non-destructive according to the habits in Section 6.
- Exported files match the technical requirements of your output goal (color space, resolution, format — see Section 6).
- You have recorded the decisions and any notes from the observational checks in Section 7.

3. CLASSICAL ART THEORY FOUNDATIONS

The definitions below follow the standard sets used in art and design foundations teaching.

3.1 Elements of Art

The seven classical elements are the irreducible visual vocabulary. Each must be deliberately controlled.

Element	Operational definition	Control considerations
Line	A mark connecting two points; may be actual, implied, or contour. Has weight, direction, continuity, and character.	Contour, construction, surface-flow direction, pattern boundaries, edge hierarchy.
Shape	A two-dimensional enclosed area. Organic vs geometric; positive vs negative.	Silhouette readability, negative-space design, figure-ground clarity.
Form	The three-dimensional equivalent of shape; volume implied by value and perspective.	Cylindrical, ovoid, spherical, planar volumes that must read as solid under light.
Value	Relative lightness or darkness independent of hue. Primary carrier of form information.	Resolve major value relationships before or independently of full color.
Color	Hue, saturation (chroma), and value together. Includes temperature and simultaneous contrast.	Local color, light-source color, shadow color, reflected light, atmospheric shifts.
Texture	Surface quality, actual or implied. Visual texture is created by mark-making patterns.	Surface character, directional stroke fields, soft vs hard transitions.
Space	Illusion of depth: overlap, size gradient, value gradient, atmospheric and linear perspective.	Placement, overlap, aerial perspective, cast shadows anchoring forms.

Standard seven-element set documented in design-education resources (e.g., university foundations materials).

3.2 Principles of Design and Composition

Principles govern how the elements are organized. Core set that appears consistently in professional design education:

- **Balance** — equilibrium of visual weight (symmetrical, asymmetrical, radial).
- **Emphasis / Focal point** — the area that draws attention first, created by contrast, isolation, or convergence.
- **Movement / Directional force** — paths the eye follows via line, edge, value gradient, or repetition.
- **Proportion / Scale** — relative size relationships.
- **Unity / Harmony** — coherence so all parts belong together (consistent light, consistent edge logic).
- **Variety** — controlled difference that prevents monotony.
- **Contrast** — difference in value, color, size, texture, or shape used for hierarchy.
- **Rhythm / Repetition** — recurring elements that create organized movement.
- **Hierarchy** — ordered ranking of visual importance.

Principles listings drawn from professional design-education resources.

3.3 Historical comparative frameworks (Wölfflin)

Heinrich Wölfflin's paired categories remain useful diagnostic tools for analyzing and maintaining stylistic consistency: Linear vs. Painterly, Plane vs. Recession, Closed vs. Open form, Multiplicity vs. Unity, Absolute vs. Relative clarity. They help you keep the same stylistic rules across an entire image.

3.4 Structural and proportional systems (general)

Regardless of subject, major masses and proportional relationships are established before surface detail. Construction methods (gesture line, envelope, major-mass blocking, cross-contour) appear across figure, object, vehicle, and environment instruction. The requirement to establish structure early is universal; the specific landmarks depend on the subject and are outside this subject-agnostic document.

3.5 Perspective systems

Linear perspective (one-, two-, three-point), atmospheric/aerial perspective, and foreshortening are the primary systems for depth. Resolve them during construction so later rendering does not fight incorrect spatial relationships.

3.6 Classical color theory

Core constructs: hue circle, complementary and analogous relationships, temperature (warm/cool), simultaneous contrast, distinction between local color and the color of light or shadow. The Munsell system (hue, value, chroma) and Johannes Itten's contrasts remain standard reference frameworks.

3.7 Value, light, and form

Value is the primary carrier of form. The classic vocabulary includes light side, form shadow (with core), reflected light, cast shadow, and contact/ambient-occlusion darkening. Many professional digital painters still begin with a grayscale value study (sometimes called a Notan study when reduced to two–four values) so structure and composition are solid before hue is introduced. Value studies are widely documented as a way to test large light/dark shapes, hierarchical contrast, and readability without the distraction of color.

3.8 Gesture, rhythm, and dynamic construction

Gesture captures the primary directional force (often called the action line or line of action), weight distribution, and relationship of major masses. In a finished work the gesture should remain readable beneath surface detail. Weak gesture is rarely rescued by later rendering. Contemporary

process writing and figure-drawing instruction consistently treat the action line as the first structural decision.

4. MODERN AND CONTEMPORARY THEORY RELEVANT TO DIGITAL PRACTICE

4.1 Gestalt principles

Proximity, similarity, continuity, closure, figure-ground, and common fate describe how viewers organize visual information. Directly applicable to silhouette design, grouping, and edge control.

4.2 Stylization consistency

Once you choose a level of finish, edge treatment, texture density, and color simplification, bringing the whole image to a unified level of finish usually produces a more coherent result. Process instructors note that viewers are often distracted by the weakest (least-finished) areas; spreading attention so that edges, materials, and secondary forms reach a comparable level of resolution helps prevent that distraction. Consistency of finish remains a practical goal rather than an absolute stylistic law.

4.3 Cognitive load, visual hierarchy, and edge control

Highest informational density and contrast should sit at the intended focal area; peripheral regions are progressively simplified in detail, contrast, and edge sharpness. Edge control (hard, firm/soft, and lost edges) is a primary tool for directing attention and describing form: hard edges attract the eye and clarify plane breaks or cast-shadow boundaries; softer edges describe turning form; lost edges merge areas of similar value and remove visual weight from secondary zones. Independent of style.

4.4 Material perception and surface optics

Understanding diffuse vs. specular reflectance, roughness, and related ideas helps even in painterly work: you approximate the aggregate optical behavior of surfaces so value and edge choices support the intended material reading.

5. COMPLETE DIGITAL PRODUCTION PIPELINE — THEORY MAPPED TO STAGE

The sequence synthesizes the order of concerns that appears in published professional illustration and concept-art process descriptions. Exact names and counts vary; the order of problems to solve does not. At every stage the actions are things **you** do.

5.0 Project definition and constraints

Governing theory: All later formal decisions are constrained by what you lock here.

What you do:

- Record every decision listed in Section 2.2 in a short written brief.
- Declare target resolution, color space, bit depth, and delivery formats (see Section 6).
- Set up a simple folder and naming scheme you can maintain.

You can move on when: The brief exists in writing and the canvas is created at the correct size and color settings.

5.1 Ideation and conceptual development

Governing theory: Gesture, intent, emotional tone, and structural readability.

What you do:

- Generate several distinct rough directions that differ in arrangement, lighting mood, or overall feeling.
- Evaluate each against the brief.
- Select one primary direction; keep the others available.

You can move on when: One direction is chosen and you can state why it fits the brief.

5.2 Reference acquisition and analytical deconstruction

Governing theory: Observational accuracy requires good visual data. References are tools, not sources to copy.

What you do:

- Collect references covering structure, lighting behavior, materials, and any environment you need.
- Break them into usable parts (structural notes, value range, surface direction).
- Keep the reference board visible while you work.

You can move on when: Reference board is organized and you know what information each piece supplies.

5.3 Thumbnailing and compositional exploration

Governing theory: Principles of design, silhouette clarity, value pattern (notan). Process descriptions place this before committed drawing.

What you do:

- Make a set of small, quick thumbnails exploring crop, arrangement, and value distribution.
- Look for strong overall shape, clear focal hierarchy, and readable directional force at tiny size.
- Select the strongest; lock crop and major mass placement.

You can move on when: Composition is selected and a small value sketch shows the intended light/dark architecture.

5.4 Construction drawing and structural scaffolding

Governing theory: Proportion, structural systems, perspective, gesture preservation.

What you do:

- On a dedicated layer or pass, construct major masses and proportional relationships.
- Establish the perspective system required by your viewpoint.
- Preserve the gesture from the thumbnail.
- Resolve structural questions before investing in surface.

You can move on when: Structure is consistent with your references and viewpoint; gesture still reads.

5.5 Refined line / clean structural drawing (optional by style)

Governing theory: Contour quality and edge hierarchy. Some painterly approaches skip a clean line stage; intentional edges remain mandatory.

What you do:

- If your style needs line, draw final contours with deliberate weight variation on a new layer.
- Hide or lower opacity of rough construction.

You can move on when: Any required line work is clean and intentional; structure is settled.

5.6 Value studies and understructure

Governing theory: Value as carrier of form; light logic; notan. Grayscale studies are a documented step in many professional workflows.

What you do:

- Create a grayscale pass establishing light side, form shadow (including core), reflected light, cast shadows, and contact darkening.
- Confirm the image already reads as three-dimensional and hierarchical with no color.
- Treat this value structure as the authority for later color work.

You can move on when: Resolved grayscale study exists and satisfies readability and light-logic checks.

5.7 Local color blocking and palette lock

Governing theory: Local color, simultaneous contrast, limited-palette harmony, temperature relationships.

What you do:

- Build a working palette that fits your lighting idea.
- Block main local colors while protecting the value structure already built.
- Record the palette for consistency across sessions.

You can move on when: Local colors are blocked, palette is recorded, value structure still holds.

5.8 Form rendering, lighting, and material response

Governing theory: Form modeling via value and temperature shifts; diffuse vs specular response.

What you do:

- Model forms by shifting value and temperature according to your light direction.
- Add highlights and material cues only as far as your style register requires.
- Do not let color destroy the value reading established earlier.

You can move on when: Forms read as solid under the chosen light; materials are differentiated.

5.9 Texture, surface detail, and micro-structure

Governing theory: Visual texture, directional marks, controlled optical density.

What you do:

- Add surface information consistent with form and light.
- Vary mark length, opacity, and direction with the turning of the form.
- Avoid even, wallpaper-like coverage.

You can move on when: Surface character is present without flattening underlying form.

5.10 Atmospheric integration and environmental cohesion

Governing theory: Atmospheric (aerial) perspective, figure-ground, edge resolution relative to depth. As forms recede they typically lose contrast, saturation, and edge sharpness and may shift toward the color of the atmosphere.

What you do:

- If an environment is present, reduce contrast, saturation, and edge sharpness with distance.
- Adjust edge hardness of the subject against the background according to depth and hierarchical importance.
- Ensure contact points and cast shadows connect forms to the ground.

You can move on when: Spatial relationships are coherent; figure-ground separation is clear.

5.11 Final pass, edge audit, and global adjustments

Governing theory: Global relationships, simultaneous-contrast correction, edge finalization, hierarchy.

What you do:

- View the image at 100 % and at thumbnail size; note failures at either scale.
- Flip the canvas horizontally (standard observational check) and look for imbalances.
- Temporarily desaturate a copy and confirm value structure still works.
- Confirm hardest, highest-contrast edges sit at the focal area.
- Verify light-direction consistency.
- Make any last selective adjustments on non-destructive layers if your software allows.

You can move on when: Image satisfies the definition of done in Section 2.3; no major structural or hierarchical problems remain.

5.12 Export, archiving, and delivery

Governing theory: Technical fidelity to your output goal and long-term recoverability.

What you do:

- Save the master file in the native layered format at full resolution and bit depth, layers still separate and clearly named.
- Export delivery files that match your brief: correct color space, correct resolution, correct format (see Section 6).
- Create a simple flattened reference version for quick viewing.
- Archive the whole project folder (master, exports, references, brief, notes) with a clear name and date.
- If you use version control, record the final state with a short note.

You can move on when: Master and delivery files exist, match technical requirements, and are safely stored.

6. DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE AND TECHNICAL STANDARDS

6.1 Software environment (tool-agnostic)

Any program that supports layers, masks or equivalent, non-destructive adjustments, and basic color management can serve. Common choices include Adobe Photoshop, Clip Studio Paint, Procreate, Krita, and Affinity Photo. Vector elements, if needed, are usually prepared in a vector program and brought in.

6.2 Practical setup notes (hobbyist-realistic)

A pressure-sensitive tablet makes control easier for most people but is not a theoretical requirement of the pipeline. What matters is that you can work at your target canvas size without constant technical friction and that you keep backups of your files. Color-critical print work benefits from a calibrated monitor; for purely screen delivery the requirement is lower.

6.3 Color management

- Screen-only delivery: sRGB is the common, safe working and delivery space.
- Print possible or likely: many workflows recommend a wider space such as Adobe RGB while working, then conversion to the printer's requested profile at the end.
- Soft-proofing (previewing the output profile while the layered file is still open) is standard advice in color-managed print preparation.
- Working in 16-bit while painting gives more tonal headroom and reduces the risk of banding during heavy adjustments; convert to 8-bit only for final delivery formats that require it.
- For print, convert to the profile the printer specifies (examples documented by print houses include U.S. Sheetfed Coated and Web Coated / SWOP variants).

Sources: Adobe color-workflow documentation; print-house profile guidance; fine-art and commercial print color-management literature. Full URLs in Bibliography.

6.4 Non-destructive habits

- Prefer adjustment layers and masks over permanently changing base pixels when your software allows it.
- Keep major stages (construction, value, local color, lighting, detail, adjustments) on separate layer groups so you can revise one without destroying the others.
- Never flatten the master file; flatten only copies you export for delivery.

6.5 File naming and folder habits

A consistent, date-stamped scheme prevents lost work. One practical pattern organizes the project into Brief/Notes, References, Working (versioned native files), Exports (Screen / Print), and Archive. Exact names are your choice; unambiguous versioning is the requirement.

6.6 Resolution and canvas standards — real-world catalog

Resolution depends on delivery context. Figures below are taken from published print-house and platform sources. Create the canvas at or above the size you will finally need; upscaling later does not recover detail.

Print at reading distance

The most widely stated standard for continuous-tone color work intended for close viewing is **300 PPI at final physical size**. Line art is frequently requested at 600 DPI. These figures appear repeatedly in comic-print guides, book-printer instructions, and commercial print documentation.

- Comic interiors (~6.625 × 10.25 in): ~1988 × 3075 px at 300 DPI; many artists work higher for line art.
- A4 at 300 PPI: 2480 × 3508 px — frequently recommended versatile starting size.
- US Letter (8.5 × 11 in) at 300 PPI: 2550 × 3300 px.
- Large-format / distance-viewed work uses lower PPI (documented examples: 150–200 for posters, 100–150 for banners, 25–72 for billboards).

Screen and platform delivery (pixel dimensions matter)

Use	Documented guidance
General portfolio / web	Long side often 2000–4000+ px; many start near A4-equivalent or ~3000 px
ArtStation-style showcase	1920 px or 3840 px width commonly discussed
Instagram feed square	Platform baseline 1080×1080; higher delivery common
Instagram 4:5	1080×1350
Story / 9:16	1080×1920
X / Twitter image	1200×675 common 16:9 example
YouTube thumbnail	1280×720
4K wallpaper	3840×2160

Platform requirements change over time. Verify every pixel dimension and aspect ratio against the current official specification pages at the moment of delivery. Full source URLs appear in the Bibliography and Claims Inventory.

Practical starting point drawn from the sources: if print is uncertain, beginning near A4 at 300 PPI (~2480×3508) or ~3000 px on the long side gives headroom for both good screen display and potential print without upscaling.

7. QUALITY CHECKS AND CRITIQUE (PERFORMED BY YOU)

All checks below are performed by you on your own screen. The AI cannot see your image and will not pretend to.

7.1 Stage-gate habit

Do not treat a stage as finished until its exit conditions (Section 5) are met. You can review them yourself or ask another person.

7.2 Observational checklist you run

- View at 100 % and at a very small thumbnail size. Note failures at either extreme.
- Flip the canvas horizontally. Unevenness and hidden tilts often become obvious.
- Desaturate a copy. If form or hierarchy collapses, the value structure needs work.
- Confirm the hardest, highest-contrast edges sit where you want attention first.
- Trace light direction across every form and cast shadow; they should agree.
- Write down every defect you find and what you will do about it.

These observational practices appear repeatedly in professional process writing.

7.3 Iteration limits

Unbounded revision is a common cause of unfinished work. Decide in advance how many major composition passes and how many value/color revision rounds you will allow before you call the piece done or formally expand the scope.

8. FAILURE MODES AND CORRECTIVE ACTIONS

Detection methods that require looking at the image are performed by you.

What you notice	Likely cause	What to try
Piece feels stiff or lifeless even if proportions look correct	Weak overall gesture / directional force	Return to thumbnail and construction; re-establish action line and major masses
Something feels off in size or placement	Proportion or perspective error	Compare with structural references; correct on construction layer and update dependents
Forms look flat after color is added	Value range too narrow or value structure abandoned	Strengthen the grayscale study; restore stronger light-to-core-shadow separation
Patterns or texture look stuck on like decals	Surface detail not turning with the form	Remap detail so it changes width, value, and edge quality as the surface turns
Colors feel muddy or shadow side loses identity	Missing temperature logic or poor saturation control in shadow	Revisit palette; keep controlled temperature shift into shadow while preserving hue identity
Everything competes for attention	No hierarchy — periphery as detailed and contrasty as the focus	Reduce contrast, detail, and edge sharpness away from the focal area
Light feels inconsistent	Conflicting light directions in form and cast shadows	Declare one primary light direction and correct every shadow and highlight to match
File becomes unrecoverable or chaotic	Layers unnamed, merged too early, or no versioning	Restore from last good version; re-establish named layer groups

9. APPENDICES

Appendix A — Recommended layer-stack template (top to bottom)

A practical synthesis of non-destructive habits reported in professional digital-painting workflows. Exact names are yours to choose; separation of concerns is the principle.

- ZZ_Adjustments (Curves, Levels, Color Balance, Selective Color, etc.)
- YY_Effects (optional atmosphere, overlays)
- XX_Details (finest accents, specular highlights)
- 10_Texture_Surface
- 09_Form_Lighting
- 08_Local_Color
- 07_Value_Understructure
- 06_Structural_Drawing or Line Art
- 05_Construction (hidden or low-opacity after construction stage)
- 04_Thumbnail_Comp (reference only)
- 03_Reference_Board (linked or placed, non-printing)
- 00_Background / Canvas

Appendix B — Color and palette construction notes

A coherent working palette is built from a restricted set of hues whose mixtures cover the range needed under your lighting idea. Value remains the primary structural carrier. Many digital painters avoid pure black for structural shadow in favor of a dark neutral with a temperature bias. Record the palette at the local-color stage. Soft-proof against the target output profile before final export.

Appendix C — Source and further-study matrix

- **Elements & Principles:** University design-foundations curricula and standard art-education resources.
- **Color theory & management:** Munsell system resources; Johannes Itten, *The Art of Color*; Adobe color-workflow documentation; print-house ICC/profile guidance.
- **Production pipelines:** Published process descriptions by working illustrators and concept-art pipeline literature.
- **Resolution & delivery:** Print-house specifications and platform pixel guidelines (full URLs in Bibliography).
- **Critique practice:** Standard observational checks (flip, desaturate, thumbnail test) documented across professional process writing.

Appendix D — Core Art-Principle Claims and Supporting Sources (minimum three URLs each)

The following core claims about art principles are each supported by at least three independent published sources. Full URLs appear in the Bibliography.

Claim: The standard elements of art used in foundations teaching are Line, Shape, Form, Value, Color, Texture, and Space.

- <https://www.nga.gov/educational-resources/elements-art>
- https://web.archive.org/web/20220614075338/http://www.getty.edu/education/for_teachers/building_lessons/elements.html
- <https://www.thehistoryofart.org/topics/elements-of-art/>
- <https://exhibo.art/blog/elements-of-art>

Claim: Common principles of design include Balance, Emphasis, Movement, Proportion/Scale, Unity/Harmony, Variety, Contrast, Rhythm/Repetition, and Hierarchy.

- <https://fiveable.me/introduction-art/unit-1/principles-design-balance-emphasis-movement-pattern-rhythm-unity-variety/study-guide/kMDZpB72ITucCm4n>
- <https://www.thehistoryofart.org/topics/principles-of-art/>
- <https://open-exam-prep.com/study-guides/praxis-art/introduction-and-visual-arts-foundations/principles-of-design>
- <https://www.extension.iastate.edu/wright/files/documents/4H635.pdf>

Claim: Wölfflin's five paired categories are Linear vs. Painterly, Plane vs. Recession, Closed vs. Open form, Multiplicity vs. Unity, and Absolute vs. Relative clarity.

- https://archive.org/stream/princarth00wlff/princarth00wlff_djvu.txt
- <https://victorianweb.org/painting/prb/wolfflin.html>
- https://api.pageplace.de/preview/DT0400.9780822392521_A35715560/preview-9780822392521_A35715560.pdf

Claim: Value is a primary carrier of form information and value studies (including limited-value / Notan studies) are a documented planning method.

- <https://streamlinepublishing.com/inside-art/the-benefits-of-value/>
- <https://jerwoodvisualarts.org/blog/how-to-make-a-value-study-before-painting/>
- <https://valuestudy.app/en/learn/art/what-is-value-study/>

Claim: Edge control (hard, soft/firm, lost edges) is used to direct attention and describe form.

- <https://cursa.app/en/page/edge-control-hard-soft-and-lost-edges-in-simple-forms>
- <https://cursa.app/en/page/contour-and-edge-control>
- <https://jerwoodvisualarts.org/blog/how-to-create-atmosphere-in-digital-painting/>

Claim: Atmospheric perspective involves progressive reduction of contrast, detail, and edge sharpness (and often saturation/temperature shift) with distance.

- <https://drawpaintacademy.com/atmospheric-perspective/>
- <https://jerwoodvisualarts.org/blog/how-to-use-atmospheric-perspective/>
- <https://artprof.org/learn/fundamentals/perpective/atmospheric-perspective/>

10. BIBLIOGRAPHY — COMPLETE DIRECT URLS OF SOURCES USED

Every technical and numerical claim in this document was checked against the following published sources. URLs are given in full as retrieved during research.

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2. <https://jerwoodvisualarts.org/blog/how-to-choose-dpi-for-digital-art/>
3. <https://lavaritte.com/blogs/digital-canvas-sizes/>
4. https://uncpress.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/03/UNCP_Digital_Art_Guidelines_v02_March2025.pdf
5. <https://www.genense.com/blog/render-resolution-guide/>
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23. <https://www.creativebloq.com/art/digital-art/my-15-steps-for-creating-concept-art-that-feels-real>
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25. <https://vsquad.art/blog/articles/define-concept-art-meaning-main-types-famous-examples/>

26. <https://www.cgspectrum.com/blog/guide-to-animation-pipeline>
27. <https://nastyrodent.com/character-concept-art-aaa-3d-pipeline/>
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End of document. Version 5.0 — Full depth restored, correct framing, complete source URLs.